In *Dr Strangelove* General Jack D. Ripper (played by Sterling Hayden) despatches the 843rd Bomb Wing to attack the Soviet Union in order to provoke an all-out nuclear war. *(Public Domain)*



General Thomas Power, Commander-in-Chief ofthe Strategic Air Command. In 1961, he told President Kennedy that if nuclear war was inevitable, the United States should strike first. *(Public Domain)*